

The Stewart's Run

A real-world racing game built around
Stewart's Shops locations across NY, VT & NH

Concept document — prepared for internal review

Prepared May 2026

Community-first

Privacy by design

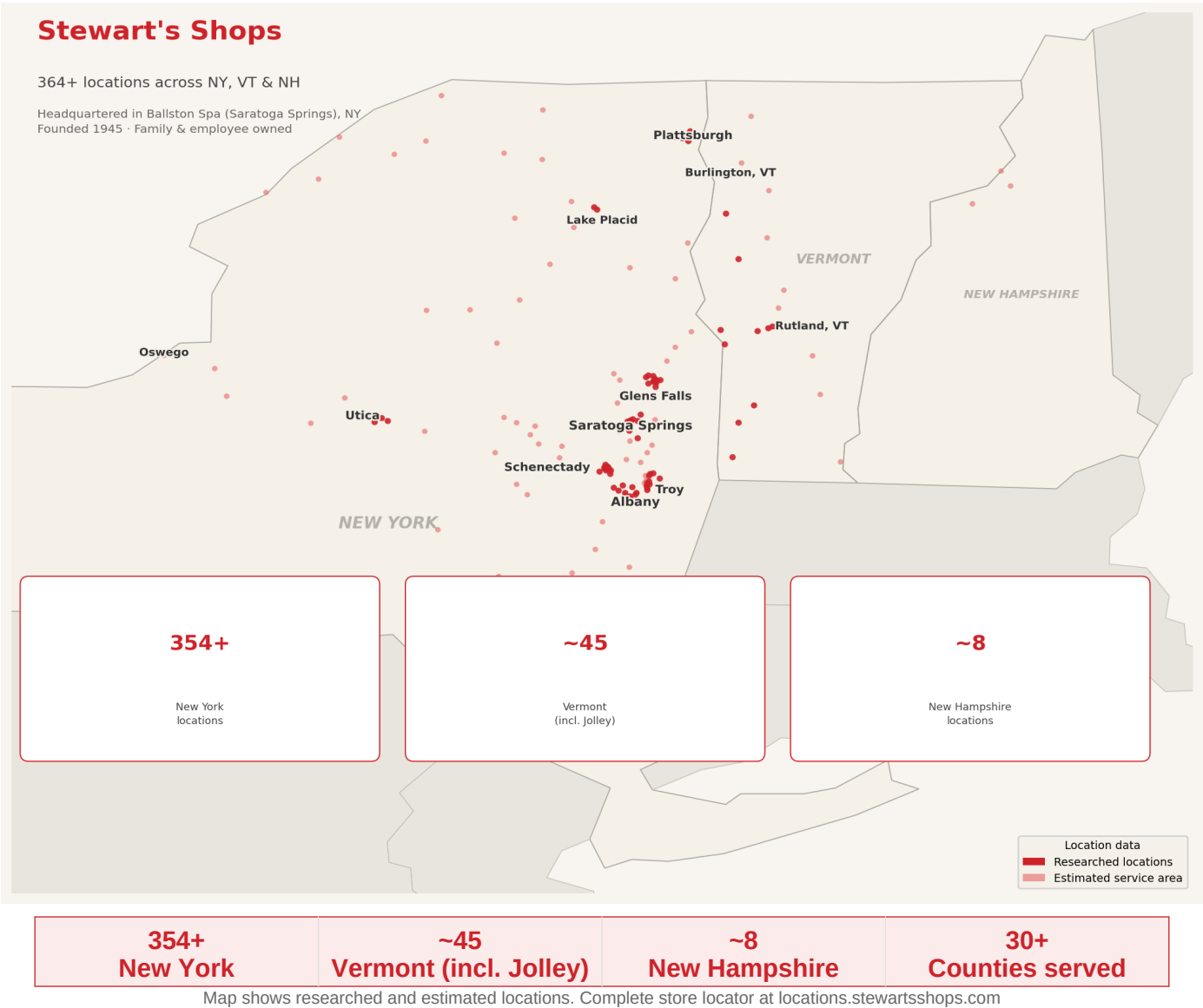
No purchase required

Powered by Scoops

Confidential — not for distribution

The footprint

Stewart's Shops spans three states and over 30 counties — from the Canadian border in the north to the edge of the New York metro area in the south, and from Oswego in the west to Vermont and New Hampshire in the east.



The concept

The Stewart's Run is a real-world racing game — inspired by the Cannonball Run — built around visiting every Stewart's Shops location across the network. Players earn **Scoops** by checking in at stores, completing counties, and earning bonus achievements.

How check-in works

A hidden QR code is placed somewhere inside each store. Players must physically walk in and browse to find it — no purchase required, but you have to be there. The code rotates placement periodically. Staff are in on the secret.

At the pump	In the register line	At home
GPS alert fires immediately. Big scan button above the fold. One tap to check in.	30 seconds to browse. See race position and nearby bonus locations.	Plan routes, track progress, browse leaderboards, check badge collection.

Bonus mechanics

Bonus	Trigger	Scoops
Loyal	Check in within range of a competitor location	+25
Pioneer	Visit a low-traffic, underserved location	+50
Dairy	Honor-system tap confirming a dairy purchase	+15

Race stages

- Heat 1 — County — First to complete every Stewart's in a single county.
- Heat 2 — State — First to complete all locations in New York or Vermont.
- Heat 3 — Full network — First to visit all 407+ locations across NY, VT & NH.
- Seasonal races — Timed events tied to local culture — track season, foliage, ski season.
- Friend sprints — Race a group of friends with an agreed timeline and stakes.

Who plays this game

Three distinct player types emerged from research into Stewart's existing customer base.

Deb M. — The Upstate Regular	42 · School administrator · Queensbury, NY
<i>"I didn't know I was competitive about this until I was."</i>	
About	Lifelong Stewart's customer. Knows staff by name. Milk punch card in wallet. Friday ice cream runs are a family institution.
How they play	Checks in organically, slowly realizes she's completing her county. Gets competitive when she sees a neighbor ahead on the leaderboard.
Wants	Simple app, no pressure, family fun, county badge.

Mike T. — The Commuter	34 · Electrician · Troy, NY
<i>"I've been playing this game for years without knowing it."</i>	
About	Stops at Stewart's every morning. Has been to 60+ locations just by following work across the region.
How they play	Realizes he's already halfway done when he downloads the app. Most naturally competitive player.
Wants	Fast check-in, Capital Region leaderboard domination, bragging rights.

Jamie R. — The Nostalgic Visitor	29 · Graphic designer · Brooklyn, NY (grew up in Glens Falls)
<i>"It's not just ice cream. It's where I'm from."</i>	
About	Moved to Brooklyn. Every visit home includes a mandatory Stewart's stop. Makes city friends try the ice cream.
How they play	Plans whole weekends around hitting as many locations as possible on visits upstate. Shares everything.
Wants	Road trip adventure, social sharing, a reason to come home more often.

Safety and privacy

Safety and privacy are foundational constraints — not features. This is especially important given Stewart's rural footprint across upstate NY, Vermont, and New Hampshire.

97%

of DV service providers report technology-facilitated abuse in their cases.
Gaming and social apps are explicitly identified platforms. — NNEDV Safety Net

Core rule — no live or near-live location sharing

- No real-time location sharing with any player, ever
- No push notifications to competitors when a player checks in
- No pattern summaries that could reveal a routine
- Minimum 24-hour delay before any activity appears in shared feeds — as a stat event only, never a location
- Competitors see scores and badges only — never which specific stores you visited or when

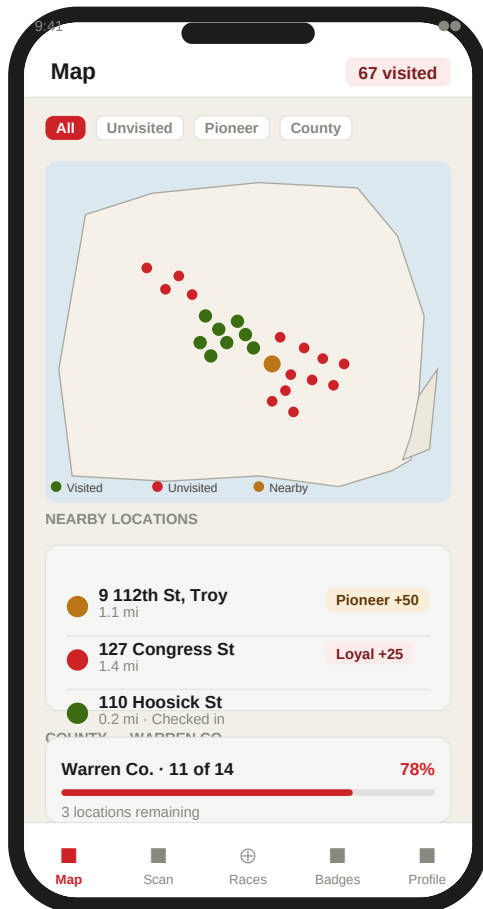
The quiet exit

Every player can instantly pause all data sharing in one tap — no explanation, no visible signal to other players, no trace. Designed for anyone who needs to go dark quickly. Non-negotiable.

New York	NYS OPDV · opdv.ny.gov · 800-942-6906 Wellspring · wellspringcares.org · 518-584-8188 Cornell Tech CETA clinic · ceta.tech.cornell.edu
Vermont	Vermont Network · vtnetwork.org · 800-228-7395 Safe at Home Address Confidentiality Program
New Hampshire	NHCADSV · nhcadsv.org · 866-644-3574
National	NNEDV Safety Net · techsafety.org · safetynet@nnedv.org · 202-543-5566

App screen — Map

The Map screen shows the full Stewart's network as a dot map, filterable by completion status. Visited locations appear in green, nearby locations in amber, unvisited in red. Tapping a location reveals bonus tags and distance.



Key elements

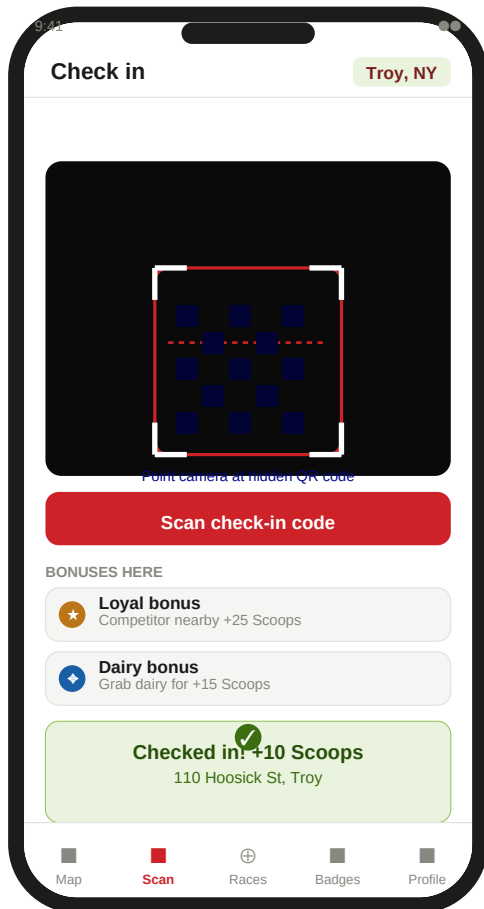
- Filter tabs — All / Unvisited / Pioneer / My county
- Color-coded dot map — green = visited, red = unvisited, amber = nearby with bonuses
- Nearby locations list with Pioneer and Loyal bonus tags
- County progress bar showing completion percentage
- Tap any dot to see location name, distance, and active bonuses

Design decisions

- Map is the natural home screen for at-home planning sessions
- Bonus tags on the nearby list surface the Pioneer and Loyal mechanics without requiring any navigation
- County progress bar keeps the most achievable milestone always visible
- No real-time location of other players is ever shown on this map

App screen — Scan (check-in)

The Scan screen is the core game mechanic. Players open this screen when they've found the hidden QR code inside a Stewart's store. The animated scanner frame makes the experience feel intentional and rewarding. Bonus confirmations appear immediately after a successful scan.



Key elements

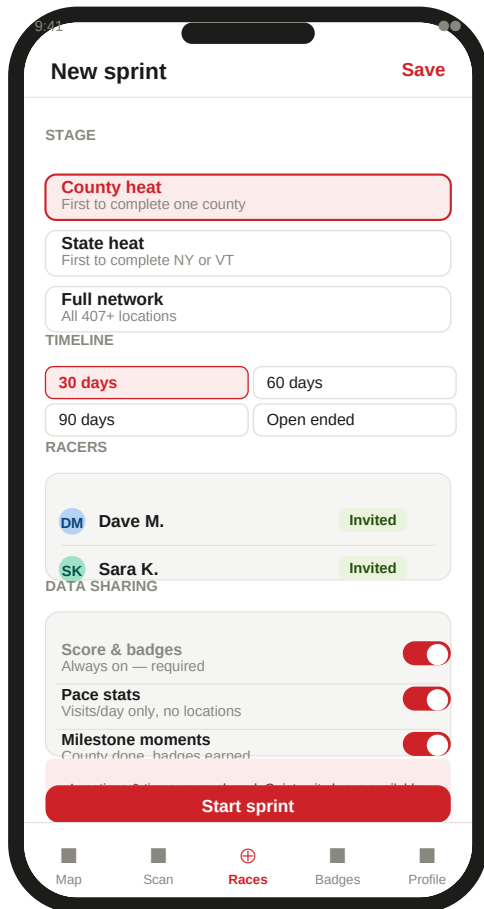
- Animated QR scanner frame with corner accents and scan-line animation
- Hint text: 'Find the hidden QR code inside the store'
- Large scan button — one tap to trigger check-in
- Loyal bonus surfaced automatically if a competitor is nearby (GPS-detected)
- Dairy bonus confirmation — honor-system tap, never verified externally
- Success state shows Scoops earned and location confirmed

Design decisions

- The scanner UI makes check-in feel like a discovery moment, not a utility action
- Dairy bonus uses honor system — no receipt scanning, no invasive verification
- Competitor proximity for Loyal bonus detected silently — competitor never named
- Success state is celebratory but brief — no interruption to the player's shopping

App screen — Sprint creation

The Sprint screen lets players set up a friend race from scratch. Stage, timeline, racers, and data-sharing preferences are all configured here before the sprint starts. The privacy note is always visible — not buried in settings.



Key elements

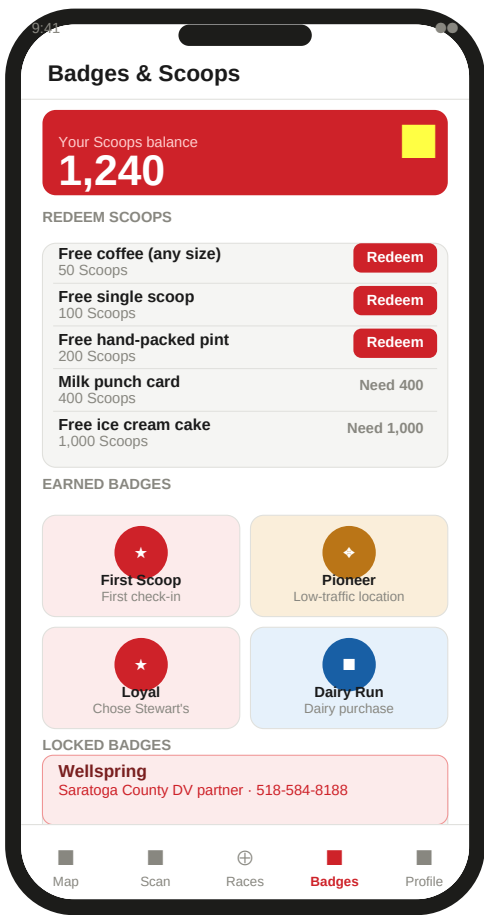
- Stage selection — County / State / Full network
- Timeline picker — 30 / 60 / 90 days / Open ended
- Friend invite list with status indicators
- Three data-sharing toggles — score (always on), pace stats, milestone moments
- Persistent privacy note: locations and times never shared
- Quiet exit reminder built into the sprint setup flow

Design decisions

- Score sharing is mandatory and locked — you can't race without a visible score
- Pace stats and milestone moments are opt-in per sprint, not global settings
- Privacy note is always visible in the sprint creation flow — not one-time consent buried in onboarding
- Quiet exit is surfaced here so players know it exists before they join

App screen — Badges & Scoops

The Badges screen is the reward hub. Players see their current Scoops balance, can redeem for Stewart's products directly, browse earned and locked badges, and find the Wellspring community card at the bottom.



Key elements

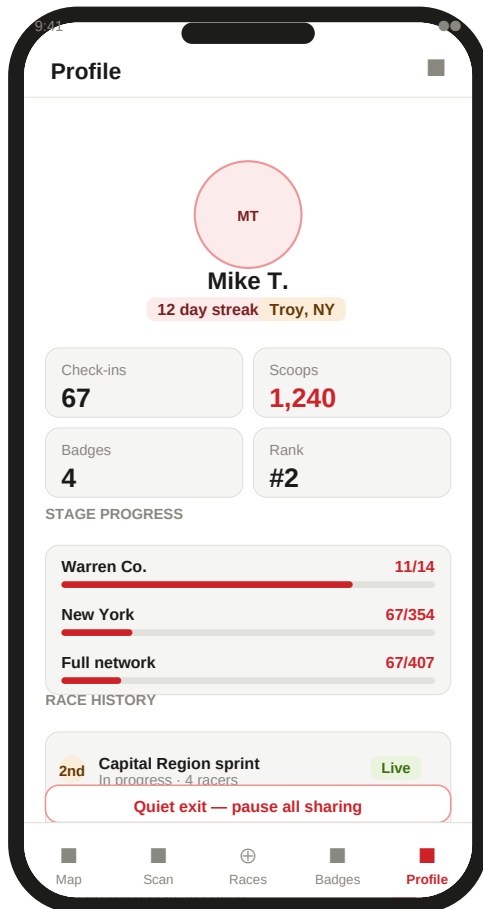
- Scoops balance — large, prominent, in Stewart's red
- Redemption menu — coffee, single scoop, pint, punch card, ice cream cake
- Redeem buttons grey out when balance is insufficient — no confusion
- Earned badges grid — First Scoop, Pioneer, Loyal, Dairy Run
- Locked badges shown at reduced opacity — motivation to keep playing
- Wellspring card at bottom — hotline, description, authentic partnership note

Design decisions

- Scoops balance is the first thing you see — clear, simple, no clutter
- Redemption is always in-store — no digital gift card, no cash equivalent
- Wellspring card is present but not intrusive — it belongs here, it's not an ad
- Locked badges show what's coming without creating pressure or anxiety

App screen — Profile

The Profile screen is the player's personal dashboard — stats, stage progress, race history, and privacy controls all in one place. The quiet exit button is prominently placed and always accessible.



Key elements

- Avatar with initials, name, streak badge, and home city
- Four stat cards — check-ins, Scoops earned, badges, all-time rank
- Stage progress bars — county, state, full network
- Race history — current and completed sprints with placement
- Privacy toggles — pace stats and milestone sharing per player preference
- Quiet exit button — prominent, red-outlined, always at the bottom

Design decisions

- Quiet exit is on the Profile screen because that's where players manage their account — it belongs here, not buried in settings
- Streak badge is motivating but low-stakes — it resets quietly, no penalty screen
- Race history shows placement without revealing which locations the player visited
- Privacy toggles here are global defaults — sprint-level overrides happen at sprint creation

Rewards — the Scoops economy

Points are called **Scoops** — rooted in Stewart's dairy and ice cream identity. Scoops have no monetary value, are never purchasable with real money, and are redeemable for Stewart's products only. *The stakes should never be high enough for a user to compromise good decision making.*

Earning Scoops

Action	Scoops
Check in at any location	10
Pioneer bonus	+50
Loyal bonus	+25
Dairy bonus	+15
Complete home county	+100
Complete a friend sprint	+75
Complete a full state	+500
Complete full network	+2,000

Spending Scoops

Scoops	Reward
50	Free coffee (any size)
100	Free single scoop
200	Free hand-packed pint
400	Milk punch card (10 stamps)
1,000	Free ice cream cake
2,500	Grand reward — TBD

Competitive landscape

Players driving between Stewart's locations will constantly encounter competitors. The Loyal bonus rewards players for choosing Stewart's when a competitor is nearby — without ever naming that competitor.

Chain	NY Locations	Notes
7-Eleven	839	Largest chain in NY. Expanding upstate after Speedway acquisition.
Speedway	256	Many upstate locations converting to 7-Eleven now.
Cumberland Farms	78 NY / 575+ NE	Regional player with dairy roots. Present in VT.
Circle K	~30 (growing)	40 new upstate franchise stores planned. One to watch.
Mirabito	Upstate NY + VT	Highway-focused. Recently expanded into VT.
QuickChek	Hudson Valley → Capital	Moving into Stewart's home territory.

Strategic timing

As Circle K and 7-Eleven expand upstate, the timing of a loyalty game is strategically smart. Deepening emotional attachment through a game that only works because of Stewart's unique community identity is a competitive advantage no national chain can replicate.

Stewart's corporate perspective

A hypothetical internal review — representing marketing, legal, operations, finance, and the Dake family — evaluating this concept as a potential sponsorship decision.

What we'd love	What keeps us up at night
• The Pioneer bonus drives traffic to rural locations nobody has made feel exciting before • The Scoops economy is clean and familiar — we already have a milk punch card • The Wellspring partnership is real and authentic, not manufactured • The safety framework reflects our 'We Are Closer To You' values genuinely • A game that only works because of who we are — not a white-label product with our logo	• Brand control — if this app has a bad day, that's our name on it, not a startup's • We don't have app infrastructure — 400+ QR codes across three states need management • Touching our POS system for Scoop redemption is a significant integration risk • We have never publicly named competitors — the Loyal bonus needs care • Underage players — our stores sell alcohol, tobacco, and lottery tickets • Liability if someone drives recklessly between locations to win a sprint

What we'd want to see before saying yes

- A working prototype tested in 10–20 Saratoga County stores before any broader rollout
- A third-party data privacy and security audit
- Legal review of the Scoops economy across NY, VT, and NH
- Wellspring's sign-off on how they're represented in the app
- A staffing and operations plan for QR code management at store level
- Terms of service explicitly addressing player safety, driving behavior, and age restrictions
- A defined sunset plan — what happens to Scoops if the game ends

Recommended path forward

The right path is a quiet, carefully scoped pilot in Saratoga County — Stewart's home territory, Wellspring's service area, and the region with the highest concentration of locations. Six months. Trusted partner. Clear success metrics. Then decide.

Phase 1 — Pilot proposal	0–3 months
• Identify a vetted development partner with location-based app experience • Engage Wellspring and NNEDV Safety Net for safety and privacy review • Define operational plan for QR code management in Saratoga County stores • Legal review of Scoops economy and terms of service across NY, VT, NH • Identify internal champion at Stewart's corporate with budget and authority	
Phase 2 — Saratoga County pilot	3–9 months
• Soft launch in 10–20 Saratoga County locations — no paid marketing • Monitor check-in rates, Scoop redemptions, and player feedback • Track impact on foot traffic at lower-volume Pioneer locations • Review safety and privacy performance against NNEDV framework	
Phase 3 — Evaluate and expand	9–12 months
• Decision point: expand to full Capital Region or pause and iterate • If expanding: build staffing plan for QR management at scale • Introduce friend sprint mechanics and state-level competition • Formal Wellspring partnership announcement tied to Holiday Match season	

Key contacts

Wellspring · wellspringcares.org
518-584-8188 (24-hour hotline)
NNEDV Safety Net · techsafety.org
safetynet@nnedv.org · 202-543-5566
NYS OPDV · 800-942-6906
VT Network · 800-228-7395
NHCADSV · 866-644-3574

Our honest bottom line

We love the spirit of this. It feels like us — the community values, the dairy roots, the rural pride, the safety commitment.

If someone brought us a polished pilot proposal with a credible tech partner, a safety review, and a staffing plan — **we'd take the meeting.**